

Strategy Retreat — proposed application flow

Adding a three-day, invite-only, paid retreat to an application built for one-evening meetups — and opening the app to members themselves.

NOT APPROVED

Prepared for the team · Source: 2026 Retreat workbook, 15 sheets · Nothing built yet

Why this document exists

The application today runs **Strategy Meetups**: one date, one venue, invite members, seat them, scan a QR code, mark attendance.

The **Strategy Retreat** is a different machine. Three full days, invite-only and selective, paid, with a long acquisition funnel running across email and WhatsApp, audiences who are not community members yet, speakers with fees and hotel nights, sponsors and partners, a multi-track agenda, rooming and transport, physical production, and a budget.

Creating a retreat through the current “Create Event” form would lose almost all of that. The retreat is not an event record — it is **a project with an event at the end of it**.

OBJECTIVE ONE Community managers can run it and track it One place for the pipeline, the messages, the speakers and the tasks — instead of fifteen spreadsheet tabs and a WhatsApp thread.	OBJECTIVE TWO Members get a different experience Accounts, self-service registration and a personal programme inside the app — not only a public link and a form.
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This is a long process and none of it has to be built at once. **Every item below has an ID.** Read it, argue with it, and come back with *apply now*, *later* or *skip* per item. The decision sheet at the end is the thing to fill in.

What we are working from

Every sheet in the workbook is a live workstream. The honest inventory:

SHEET	WHAT IT REALLY IS
Actions	Task tracker — task, owner, due date, comments
COMMUNICATION PLAN	A three-phase funnel: outreach → invitation to registrants → payment by JRNY
MESSAGES	Message templates per audience and stage, with [Name] merge fields
Speakers	Speaker pipeline <i>and</i> commercials — status, assignee, next action, fee, nights, room type, transport, discounts, sponsorship packages
Contents	Speaker bios and the five content pillars of the retreat

SHEET	WHAT IT REALLY IS
Partners	Vendors and partners — roster, owner, status
POTENTIAL SPONSORS	Sponsor pipeline with contacts and status
Agenda	Three days in 30-minute slots, with parallel tracks, meals, travel, prayer, night experiences
Branding Elements	Production checklist — item, quantity, status, action, plus media costs
ASSETS	Collateral status: registration form, proposal, video, delegates form
Guests	International guests (KSA / UAE / Bahrain) referred through Strategy Inc.
B2B	Corporate hit-list for group bookings — company, title, name, mobile
Reachout List	Company-level reach-out with invitee counts, and people to ask for referrals
Linkedin -Strategy Heads	Cold LinkedIn outreach to strategy heads, with per-person status
0	The community email list

Four of those sheets — **Guests**, **B2B**, **Reachout List** and **Linkedin -Strategy Heads** — are the same thing seen four ways: **people we want in the room, at different stages, from different sources**. That is one pipeline, not four lists.

Add a **Retreat** to the application as its own workspace — a project, not an event — with two surfaces on top of it: an **Ops Console** for the team and a **Member Space** for members. Meetups keep working exactly as they do today.

Part A · The Ops Console

One retreat, one workspace, tabs across the top. Each module replaces a workbook sheet or a manual habit.

A1 Retreat workspace

The container everything hangs off: name and edition, **start and end date** — the current event model holds only a single date — venue, capacity, status, price tiers (individual, group, community discount) and target revenue. Created through a short wizard rather than one long form: basics → commercials → agenda skeleton → owners.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 1

A2 Invitation pipeline — the heart of it

One row per person we want in the room, moving through explicit stages:



Each row carries a **source** (community database, referral and who referred, corporate B2B, LinkedIn outreach, partner), a **batch** for invitation waves, an **owner** and next action, a **touch log** of every email, WhatsApp and call, and **company grouping** so “*Elabd — confirmed — 3 attendees*” works as a group booking the way the reach-out sheet already treats it.

The app already scores members on level, experience and communication. That score can propose Batch 1 automatically instead of the team filtering the community by hand.

REPLACES **GUESTS, B2B, REACHOUT LIST, LINKEDIN** · PROPOSED PHASE 1

A3 Communication plan and message log

The three phases become real objects. Each step is an activity, a channel (email or WhatsApp) and a **target segment defined as a filter on the pipeline** — “registered but not confirmed”, “invited and never opened” — plus the stored template with merge fields.

For the first version the app **builds the recipient list and the personalised message text, and logs what was sent**. It does not send email or WhatsApp itself. WhatsApp is manual today anyway, and this keeps the first release small. Automated sending is a separate decision (Q3).

REPLACES **COMMUNICATION PLAN, MESSAGES** · PROPOSED PHASE 1

A4 Speakers

Status (confirmed, interested, pending, out, no response), assignee, next action, bio and photo — and the commercial side: engagement type (one-day invitation, community discount, paid fee), nights, room type, transport, cost, and which agenda sessions they are on.

REPLACES **SPEAKERS, CONTENTS** · PROPOSED PHASE 2

A5 Sponsors and partners

Pipeline, package, amount, contacts, status, owner — the same shape as the invitation pipeline, but for organisations.

REPLACES **POTENTIAL SPONSORS, PARTNERS** · PROPOSED PHASE 2

A6 Agenda builder

A day-by-day grid in 30-minute slots with **parallel tracks** — the programme has four parallel expert sessions, four parallel business cases and two levels of vibe coding. Each block has a type (session, meal, break, travel, prayer, night experience), an optional speaker, a room and a capacity. Capacity per track is what later lets members choose their own programme without overfilling a room.

REPLACES **AGENDA** · PROPOSED PHASE 3

A7 Logistics and daily check-in

Rooming (single or shared, nights, roommate), transport groups (bus, Cairo departure), and **check-in per day** — three days cannot be tracked with a single “attended” flag. The QR code and scanner already built for meetups get reused here.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 3

A8 Production checklist

Item, quantity, status (we have it, to be purchased, to be rented), owner and cost — feeding the budget.

REPLACES **BRANDING ELEMENTS** · PROPOSED PHASE 4

A9 Budget

Revenue lines (tickets, sponsorship) against cost lines (speaker fees and nights, media, branding, logistics), pulled from the speakers, sponsors and production modules. This is the module most reasonable to leave in Excel — see Q4.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 4

A10 Tasks

Task, owner, due date, status, comments — filtered to the retreat, visible to everyone working on it.

REPLACES **ACTIONS** · PROPOSED PHASE 1

A11 Assets

Registration form, proposal, retreat video, delegates form — link plus status, so “to be done” is visible rather than remembered.

REPLACES **ASSETS** · PROPOSED PHASE 1

Part B • The Member Space

This is the part that changes the member's experience rather than the manager's. Today a member's only contact with the system is a public link and a form. Here, members get an account and a place of their own.

B1 Member accounts

Members already exist in the database as records. This gives those records a **login**. Recommended: **no passwords**. A member enters their email or phone and receives a one-time code. Two entry paths — **claim your profile**, where the member is already in the community database and the code proves it is them; and **new sign-up**, where someone who found us through the retreat lands in the pipeline as a new lead pending review. Staff logins and member logins stay entirely separate systems (C3).

REPLACES — • PROPOSED PHASE 1

B2 Self-service profile

The member keeps their own data current — title, company, LinkedIn, photo, phone. One of the open items in the workbook is literally *"fill community missing data"*; this turns a chasing task into something members do themselves.

REPLACES A MANUAL FOLLOW-UP TASK • PROPOSED PHASE 2

B3 The retreat, inside the app

Instead of a public link to a PDF: the proposal, the speakers and their bios, the content pillars, the agenda, the venue and the price — as a page in the app, with one button. **Express interest, or register**. The public landing page still exists for people with no account. Both routes feed the same pipeline.

REPLACES PUBLIC LINK AND PDF • PROPOSED PHASE 1

B4 "Where do I stand?"

A member sees their own status — registered, confirmed, payment, delegates form, ready — and what is needed from them next. This is the single biggest reduction in follow-up load for the team. Most of the chasing in Phase 2 of the communication plan exists because the member has no way to see their own state.

REPLACES PHASE-2 WHATSAPP CHASING • PROPOSED PHASE 1

B5 Delegates form, in-app

Rooming preference, roommate, transport, dietary needs, arrival time — filled by the member, visible instantly in logistics, with no separate form to reconcile.

REPLACES DELEGATES FORM • PROPOSED PHASE 2

B6 Build my programme

The member chooses which of the parallel expert sessions and business cases they will attend, and gets a personal three-day schedule. For the team this produces **track capacity in advance** — how many people in each of the four parallel rooms — which is currently unknowable until the day itself.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 3

B7 Digital badge and daily check-in

The member's QR code lives in the app and is scanned on arrival each day. The QR infrastructure already exists for meetups.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 3

B8 Attendee directory and networking

Opt-in. Who else is coming, what they do, and — reusing the seating plan already in the app — who is at my table. Optionally, request an introduction. This is the reason many people come to a retreat, and it is currently invisible to them.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 4

B9 Live during the retreat

Today's schedule, what is next, room changes, announcements. Three days have enough moving parts that a printed agenda goes stale by lunch on day one.

REPLACES **PRINTED AGENDA** · PROPOSED PHASE 3

B10 After the retreat

Session materials, photos, the feedback survey, the manifesto output, and the connections made. This is what turns a three-day event into a reason to come back next year.

REPLACES — · PROPOSED PHASE 4

B11 Refer a peer

The workbook has a referral message template and a list of people to ask for referrals, all handled by hand. A member referring someone from their own account drops that person straight into the pipeline with the referrer recorded.

REPLACES **REFERRAL MESSAGES** · PROPOSED PHASE 2

B12 Meetups too, or retreat only?

The same account could carry meetup invitations and RSVPs, not just the retreat. That is a scope decision rather than a technical one — see Q5.

REPLACES — · SCOPE DECISION

Part C • Foundations

These are not features. They are the decisions everything else rests on.

C1 Retreats sit beside events, not inside them

Meetup events stay exactly as they are. A retreat is a separate thing in the database. Adding a “type” flag to events would drag multi-day dates, money, speakers and agendas into the meetup flow and make both worse.

C2 One people registry

Members, retreat registrants, B2B contacts and LinkedIn leads all live in the **same** member table, with new fields for **source** and **country** — the guest list spans Egypt, KSA, UAE and Bahrain and we currently have nowhere to record that. One directory means a retreat registrant can graduate into the community, and a member’s profile shows their whole history — meetups and retreats together. A second people table would guarantee duplicates.

C3 Two separate login systems

Staff accounts and member accounts are different realms with different sessions and different permissions. A member must never be able to reach the ops console, pipeline notes, costs, or another member’s phone number. Security review is required before this ships.

C4 Privacy

The attendee directory is **opt-in**. We need an explicit decision on what one member can see about another — name, title, company and photo, yes; phone and email only if that member chose to share. Internal fields such as score, membership type, pipeline notes and guest status are never member-visible.

C5 Payment

Working assumption: **JRNY handles the money**. The app records payment status and stores the payment link; it does not process payments. To be confirmed in Q2.

Part D • Suggested sequence

The dates in the workbook are the constraint. Phase 1 is scoped to what unblocks the September retreat, including the landing page and the forms already sitting on the action list.

PHASE	CONTENTS	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
1	Workspace, pipeline, communication plan, tasks, assets, member accounts, retreat page, my status	Running the retreat out of the app instead of the workbook — plus the landing page and registration form that are already due

PHASE	CONTENTS	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
2	Speakers, sponsors and partners, self-service profile, delegates form, referrals	Closing the commercial side and retiring the manual forms
3	Agenda builder, logistics, build my programme, digital badge and daily check-in, live view	The on-site experience
4	Production checklist, budget, attendee directory, after the retreat, funnel analytics	Everything measurable — and the reason to come back

Part E · Questions for the team

These change what gets built. We need answers before Phase 1 starts.

Q1 Do members get accounts at all, or is the retreat public-link only this year?

RECOMMENDATION

Accounts — but only the thin version in Phase 1: login, retreat page, my status.
Everything else in the Member Space can wait.

Q2 Payments — is it confirmed that JRNY handles the money and the app only tracks status?

NOTE

Taking payment inside the app is a much larger security and compliance conversation. Tracking status is a field; processing money is a project.

Q3 Does the app send messages, or only prepare them?

RECOMMENDATION

Prepare only, for now. Generating the list and the personalised text saves most of the effort; sending introduces email deliverability and WhatsApp Business API work.

Q4 Does the budget go into the app, or stay in Excel?

RECOMMENDATION

Keep the budget in Excel for this edition, but hold speaker cost in the speakers module so nothing is re-typed. Fees and discounts are sensitive data.

Q5 Is the Member Space retreat-only, or the whole community?

TRADE-OFF

Retreat-only is faster. Community-wide is the better long-term answer and matches the “community website experience” item already on the action list.

Q6 Non-member leads — same table as members?

RECOMMENDATION

Yes, one registry with a source field. Confirm nobody objects to B2B and LinkedIn contacts sitting alongside community members.

Q7 What can members see about each other?

NEEDED

An explicit answer before the directory is built — this is a promise to members, not a setting.

Q8 Who owns data entry once this exists?

WARNING

The tool only helps if the pipeline is the source of truth. If half the team keeps updating the workbook, we end up maintaining both.

Decision sheet

Fill the last column with *apply now*, *later* or *skip*, and bring it back.

ID	ITEM	REPLACES	PHASE	DECISION
A1	Retreat workspace	—	1	
A2	Invitation pipeline	Guests, B2B, Reachout, LinkedIn	1	
A3	Communication plan and message log	Communication plan, Messages	1	
A4	Speakers	Speakers, Contents	2	
A5	Sponsors and partners	Potential sponsors, Partners	2	
A6	Agenda builder	Agenda	3	
A7	Logistics and daily check-in	—	3	
A8	Production checklist	Branding Elements	4	
A9	Budget	—	4	
A10	Tasks	Actions	1	
A11	Assets	Assets	1	
B1	Member accounts	—	1	
B2	Self-service profile	“Fill missing data” task	2	
B3	Retreat page in-app	Public link and PDF	1	
B4	My status tracker	Phase-2 chasing	1	
B5	Delegates form in-app	Delegates form	2	
B6	Build my programme	—	3	
B7	Digital badge and daily check-in	—	3	
B8	Attendee directory and networking	—	4	
B9	Live during the retreat	Printed agenda	3	
B10	After the retreat	—	4	
B11	Refer a peer	Referral messages	2	
B12	Member Space covers meetups too	—	scope	
C2	One people registry, plus source and country	—	1	
C3	Separate member and staff logins	—	1	
C4	Member privacy rules	—	1	
C5	Payment tracked, not processed	—	1	

Once the decisions come back, the next step is the database schema and the Phase 1 build. Nothing in this document has been implemented.